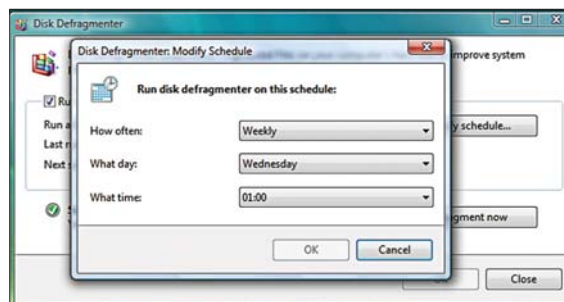


will be handled by the new default search engine.

Automating Drive Defragging Sessions

Defragging is a must. Vista has an inbuilt scheduling feature that allows you to set when you want your drives to

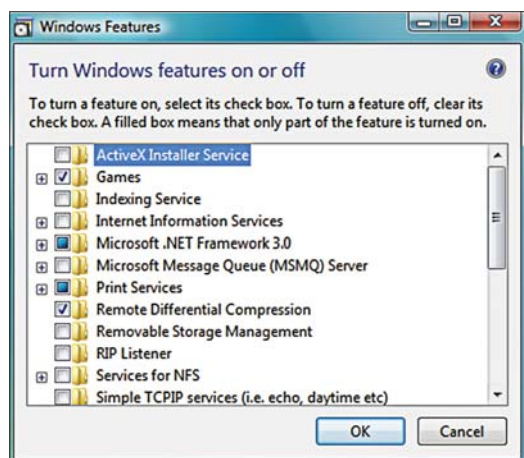


Users can now set when they want their system to be defragged

be defragged. Start Disk Defragmenter. Click on **Modify Schedule** and select when you want the defragging to take place. You can set the frequency, the day and time for the defragment process.

Turn Off Unnecessary Features

Vista comes bundled with a whole lot of features you don't always need. These can be turned off to save resources and speed up the computer a



Disabling unnecessary Vista features can save space and resources

bit. Go to **Start > Control Panel > Programs > Turn Windows Features on or off**. A list of installed components will be displayed and the ones not required like **Tablet PC Optional Components** and **Fax and Scan** can be removed. Uncheck the boxes for these components and click **OK**.

An Advanced Right-click Menu

The right-click is the quickest way to access and work with files. The Vista right-click menu has a few more

options that are hidden away. To be able to use these, hold down [Shift] when right-clicking. If you do this to a folder, you can launch a command prompt at that location. You will now be able to copy the path of a file or a folder using that menu much quicker than usual.

Removing Vista And Its Boot Loader

If you have Vista and XP in dual-boot and want to get rid of Vista, its boot loader is an obstacle. To get rid of Vista, insert your Windows XP CD and boot from it. Remember to set your first boot device as your CD/DVD drive. Press a key when it tells you to during boot up. When prompted, press [R] to load the

Recovery

console. Confirm your Windows installation by entering the number. Enter your Administrator password at the prompt. On the prompt, type **fixmbr** and then type **fixboot**.

Reboot and you should be able to boot into Windows XP. Make sure you have backed up all critical files. Then format the partition on which Vista was installed to clear out Vista.

Another way to do this is to insert your Windows Vista CD and boot into Windows XP as usual. Go to **Start > Run**, type **X:\boot\bootsec.exe /nt52 ALL /force**. (Replace X with your CD/DVD drive letter). Reboot and format the Vista partition.

Using Parental Control

Not only can parental control in Vista safeguard your children from inappropriate content, it can also regulate the way they use the computer. Go to **Start > Control Panel > User Accounts and Family Safety** and click on **Set up parental controls**.

You can create a new account for your children by clicking on **Create a new user account** or just choose an existing account. Here, click **On**, enforce current settings. Other setting that you will find here are time limits, and program, Internet and game access restrictions.

Recently Opened Items

As in Windows XP, Vista has a small list that shows all files that were opened recently. By default, the value is set to 15. This number can be changed through a registry tweak. Start registry editor (**Start > Run > regedit**). Browse to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer**. Here, right-click in the right pane and create a new 32-bit DWORD called **MaxRecentDocs**. Double-click on the entry and give it a Decimal type value of how many entries you want in the recently opened file list. Reboot when you're done and the changes will be applied.

If you do not want to have a list of recently opened files at all, the easier way is to right-click on the taskbar and click on **Properties**. Click on the **Start Menu** tab

Useful Shortcuts

Bring gadgets sidebar into focus	[Windows] + [Spacebar]
Cycle between gadgets	[Windows] + [G]
Launch nth Quicklaunch application	[Windows] + [Application number in Quicklaunch]
Cycle between 3D objects	[Windows] + [Tab]
Cycle through programs in taskbar	[Windows] + [T]
Quickly viewing file details in Explorer	[Ctrl] + [Mouse scroll]
Show all subfolders under a folder	[Num Lock] + [*]

and uncheck the "Store and display a list of recently opened files" box.

Tweaking Indexing

If you set Vista to index all files on your drive, this can take quite a while. Chances are, you will not be searching for INI files in the **C:\Windows\system32** anytime soon. You can speed up the process by selecting only the most important locations to be indexed. Get to the **Indexing Options** by going to **Start > Control Panel > System and Maintenance > Indexing Options**. Now, go to **Modify > Show all locations**. Here you can select which folders you want indexed. Clicking on **Advanced** in the **Indexing Options** window will let you set filters for file types as well.

ADOBE FLASH CS3

The latest version of Adobe Flash is part of the CS3 badge. It's got a new look and we're bringing you a whole bunch of tweaks for Flash novices.

Customize Your Toolbars

Toolbars are the quickest way to access tools, but Flash has so many tools that it's not possible to have all of them